

contrast, our collective memory of the past often is regarded as a hallowed set of truths that are passed down and become the shared heritage of a community. In the United States, this dissonance between history and memory is at its most extreme when it comes to the Civil War.

The battle for the historical memory of the Civil War began almost as soon as the shooting stopped, and it persists to this day. Just six years after the fighting ended, Frederick Douglass lamented how the legacy of the war was already being recast when he said “we are sometimes asked in the name of patriotism to . . . remember with equal admiration those who struck at the nation’s life, and those who struck to save it—those who fought for slavery and those who fought for liberty and justice.”

Since the last edition of this visual survey, many Americans have called for a historical reckoning to resist the erasure and revisionism of uncomfortable history. The nation has seen many honorific monuments to the slaveholders’ rebellion come down from public spaces across America, as well as new stories come to the forefront, including the adoption of Juneteenth—when the power of United States Army finally arrived in Texas on June 19, 1865 to enforce emancipation—as a national holiday.

In this edition, we have considered how even the language we used to describe the conflict has implications on how it is remembered. In the following pages, for instance, people held in bondage are referred to as “enslaved” rather than “slaves,” and those who supported slavery as “enslavers.”